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EXAMINING THE MAGNITUDE AND INTERPERSONAL CONNECTIONS BETWEEN EPSTEIN'S EMAIL NETWORK

Analyzing Jeffrey Epstein's network of email correspondants

Overview

On July 6th, 2019, Jeffrey Epstein was arrested in New Jersey. He was an American financier who built a network of wealthy contacts while running a private investment firm. However, in 2019, he was charged with the sex trafficking of minors.

Epstein's career first started when he was able to leverage his success at Bear Stearns to raise capital for his own firm, claiming to manage only "qualified investors." He later developed a reputation for delivering high returns, which attracted clients such as Leslie Wexner, the founder of L Brands, which owned many influential companies such as Victoria's Secret. Wexner's financial backing gave Epstein a permanent residence in New York and later a private island in the U.S. Virgin Islands. Epstein also cultivated relationships with politicians, academics, and entertainers through philanthropy and social events at his Manhattan townhouse, Palm Beach mansion, and his infamous island.

Why is it Important?

These social, political, and financial connections matter because they illustrate how Epstein's private wealth and social events created a conduit for elite networking, which later became a focal point for investigations into whether any of them were complicit or merely aware of his illegal activities.

In short, these networks act as a blueprint of how Epstein's high-profile criminal enterprise operated, who facilitated it, and where the blind spots were. Analyzing this network will not only help us build a better understanding of this specific case but also build knowledge and tools that can deter or detect similar abuses in the future.

What We're Studying

While we could explore every single connection that Epstein had to every person mentioned in the Epstein Files, following the Epstein Files Transparency Act in 2026, we instead decided to study a smaller subsection of Epstein's network, that being his email correspondence.

The dataset that we have decided to analyze is the magnitude and interpersonal connections between members who were in correspondence with Jeffrey Epstein through the documented email logs from the Epstein Files. While we are primarily pulling our data from a website called Jmail, the creators of the website have linked the Republican Oversight Committee and the Department of Justice websites as the ultimate source of their data.

Our main question was whether or not the greatest parts of Epstein's email network were actually people of great social, financial, and political influence, or if they were simply staff members hired by Epstein to complete various work. We also wanted to see if these members of his network were consistent with their correspondence over the years, or if the amount of this correspondence decreased over time.

What We're Arguing

Our argument aims to make clear how imperative Jeffery Epstein's social network was in his ability to break the law, forge the truth, and avoid legal repercussions until his arrest in 2019. Epstein surrounded himself with patrons of every profession to create a network in which he had power and influence over those in law enforcement, legal teams, financial power, and many other realms.

Epstein was a master at not only recruiting people to his network but, more interestingly, keeping them in. Again, we do not aim to accuse patrons of wrongdoing simply by association, rather to study how their support and relations with Epstein allowed him to create a wall of protection no matter the wrongdoing.

Note: This project is based on the data available as of May 2026 following the Epstein Files Transparency Act. Any court documents or data released afterwards is not applicable to this study.

Methodology

Data Collection

When deciding how we wanted to collect our data, we knew simply sifting through every published document from the Epstein Files trying to find all the email logs would take too much time. Instead, we relied on this website called Jmail for our data collection.

Jmail is a website meant to be a visual replica of what Jeffrey Epstein's Gmail account would have looked like from his perspective. The site was created by Luke Igel and Riley Walz, and it includes all the email logs that were listed in the Epstein Files. This made our data collection much simpler because all of the data we were looking for was in one place.

Upon further investigation into this website, we found a section called "Browse All People" that listed every single person who had sent an email to Jeffrey Epstein, as well as the number of emails they had sent him since 2004. This once again gave us a simplified version of the exact data we were looking for. We then collected the data of the top 50 correspondents in Epstein's email network (including Epstein himself), as we felt that number was a good sample representation of what we were trying to study.

Click on the button below to view the Browse All People section of Jmail.

[Jmail - Browse All People](#)

R Methodology

We decided to lay out the data in a way that could easily distinguish the correlation between the amount of correspondence with Epstein and the year, to visualize the timeline of Epstein's interpersonal relationships.

We used JMail to create our own dataset that could then be used in R with ggplot to create our visualization. This dataset included the names of the top fifty people in email correspondence with Epstein, the years they were in contact, their job description (which was not used for this specific finding), and how many total emails they had sent to Epstein .

Click on the button below to view our original CSV File.

[Original CSV File](#)

Gephi Methodology

We used Gephi to visualize the structural relationships in Epstein's network. Using the data from Jmail we made a node file that listed each individual and their occupation, and an edge file that had the total number of emails and years the communication started and ended. It ranked them by email weight so thicker nodes are the high email senders.

Click on the buttons below to view our Nodes and Edges Files.

[Edges File](#)

[Nodes File](#)

Graphy Methodology

Graphy was used to create a bar chart ranking the top fifteen email senders. We used the same dataset for R. Uploaded it and made a horizontal chart with the individual's name, occupation, and total emails. This visualization was used to make the Gephi network easier to read and straightforward

Click on the button below to view the Top 20 CSV File.

[Top 20 CVS File](#)

Limitations

One of the limitations we experienced was our inability to see the content of the emails themselves, leaving us no way to know the meaning or sentiment behind them. Sure, we could see who was sending the email, their profession, and infer their relationship with Epstein, but our interpretation was limited due to a lack of content.

Without knowing the true intent and tone behind the emails, we are left to speculate - which goes beyond the goal of our research. Our goal was not to accuse, yet to study Jeffery Epstein's financial, social, and political network and how those connections may have supported him.

This project is being presented in May of 2026, meaning that any data found after the fact is not applicable.

Law enforcement has restrictions on much of the data surrounding the Epstein Files, and because of this our data was limited, as well as our sources. The individuals mentioned in our data sets are based on public knowledge, meaning that is does not imply criminal wrongdoing, guilt, or personal involvement in illegal activity.

Data Analysis

Figure 1

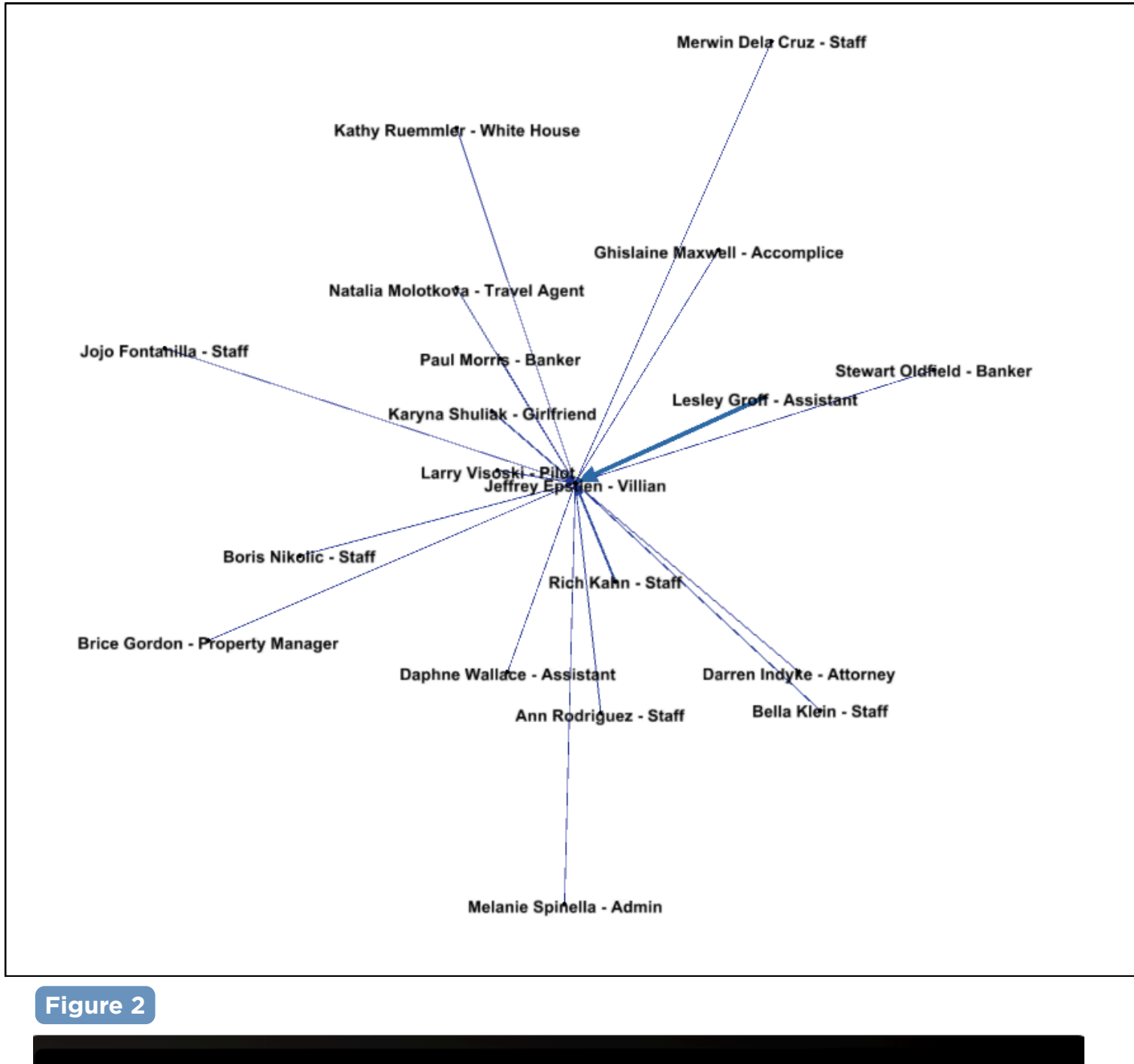
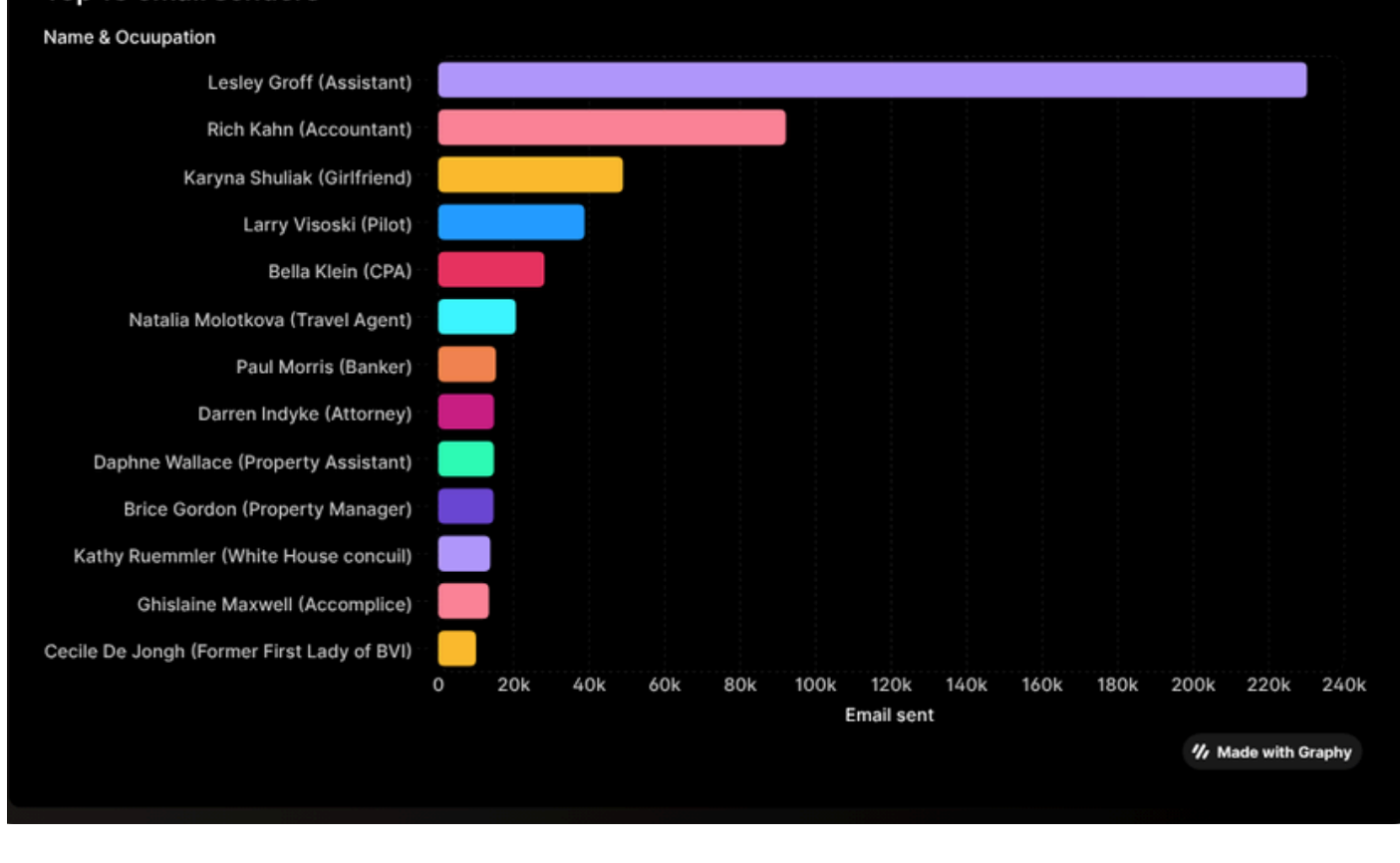


Figure 2



These visualizations show Epstein's top 15 email senders. The data was drawn from Jmail which we used to create our own dataset to work with in Gephi. The bar chart and Gephi network visualizations show the same story in different ways. The bar chart shows precisely how many emails each person sent. The Gephi network shows how everything links with Epstein being in the middle.

A closer look at the data in the bar graph shows that his assistant doubled the amount of Rich Khan, his accountant, and second on the list. It makes you think that the communication might have been happening through one main person rather than between different people. We used Gephi to better illustrate and explain our visualization. Each bar on the graph represents a person with the occupation, and the horizontal axis measures the amount of email sent. There was a substantial number of people in Epstein's network, but what we noticed is how the majority of the communication is with his smaller behind-the-scenes group of people. His accountant comes in second, matching the nodes seen in the Gephi visualization. Most of the nodes in the network are not politicians or celebrities like we would imagine, but the everyday staff that was managing his operations.

The data also reveals that his documented accomplice, Ghislaine Maxwell, appears to be very low in the senders' graph. This might bring up questions like if they had different communication methods, if more of their emails were suppressed, or if she did more of the in-person role. This also helps connect what Professor Cook brings up in his article, that it was purposefully made hard to see and understand what was going on when they were hiding the connections. Another interpretation that can be supported by victims is that her role was mainly in person recruiting, face to face. All of these interpretations can overlap, and the data itself can't resolve or give an answer. What it can do is show what is missing. This is what Cook (2023) uses as an argument in her analysis that the non-prosecution agreement was made to hide Epstein's network. The visualizations do more than just show what was recorded but hint at what might have been purposely suppressed

Figure 3

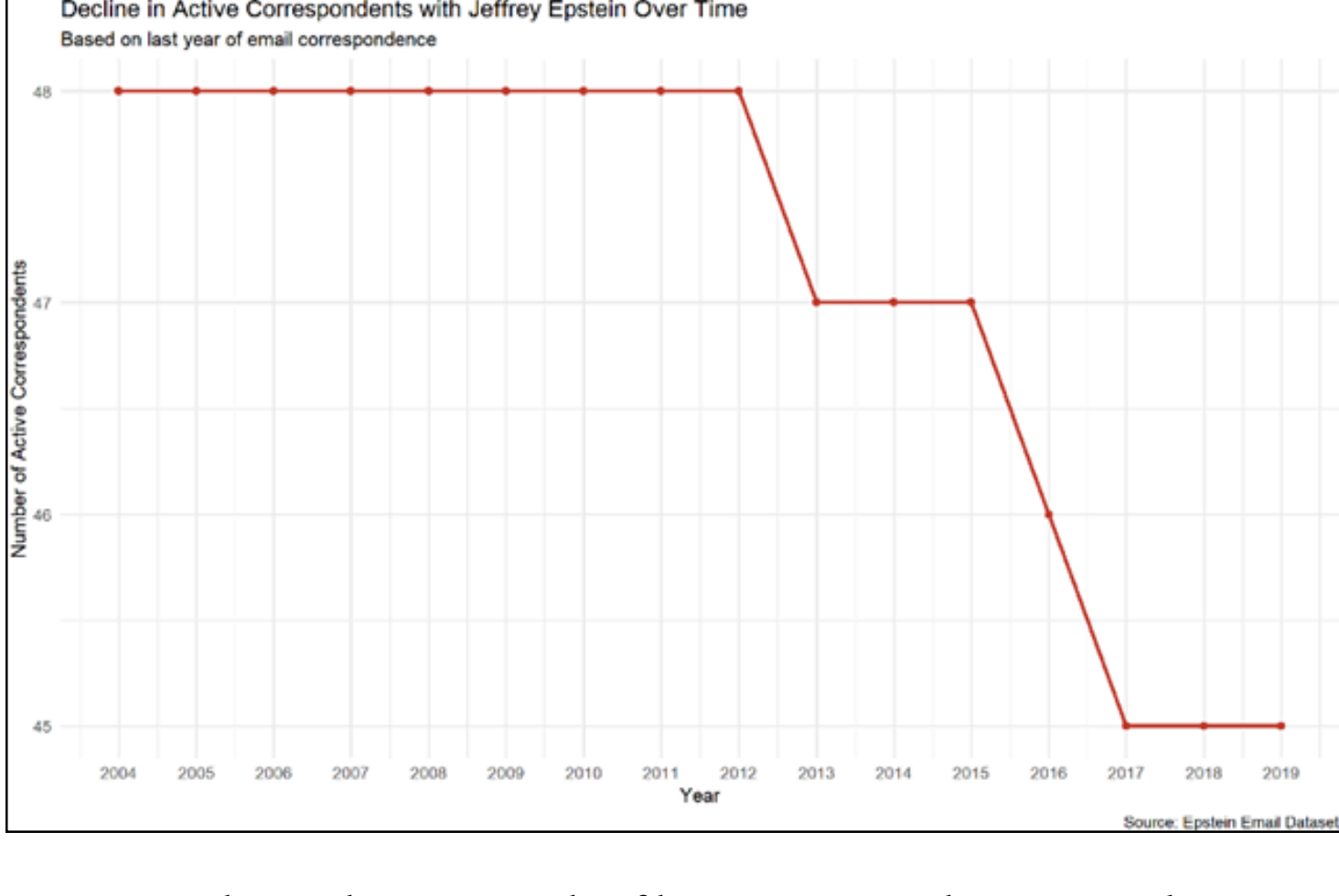


Figure 3 shows the magnitude of how correspondence went down in Epstein's relationships as time went on. (One specific thing we want to draw attention to is that correspondence never went down to zero, so the bottom of the graph represents 45. This is important to note that there are still people in communication with Epstein up until 2019 when he dies, and that when the line is at the bottom of the graph it does not mean that he was in correspondence with no one.) There are two noticeable dips in correspondence, in 2013 and 2015. While it is hard to interpret why this happens because much of the data is not available to the public, we think the dip in 2013 could have something to do with his partnership with Israeli Minister of Defense, Ehud Barak, or that JP Morgan Chase severed ties with him in 2013, as many of his correspondents were his bankers with Chase (Goodman). As for the larger dip in correspondence beginning in 2015, this is an obvious effect of Virginia Roberts Giuffre filing a sexual assault claim against Prince Andrew and Epstein (Popoola). This was the beginning of Epstein's new title as a known sex trafficker.

So, we understand that Epstein's personal email correspondence decreased when he went through major life events, but why does this matter. Well, we can infer that when these dips in correspondence happened, Epstein's personal relationships with those people also were most likely severed. However, this data also represents that interpersonal relationships are complicated, and a relationship might not be severed in one year but rather be dragged out multiple years (like from 2015 - 2017). If all people Epstein was in contact with in 2015 abruptly stopped correspondence the dip would go straight down, however we see that it is a gradual decrease of correspondence. It is important to note that correspondence with Epstein can be tracked back to 1990, however for our specific use we chose to begin with the year 2004 because this is when Gmail was invented and out for public use. By 2004, 2 people had already severed contact, and that is why we start with 48 correspondents instead of the original 50. Also, we notice that only 5 people have stopped contact with Epstein over the 16 years. This goes to prove our overall argument, that Jeffrey Epstein was a very powerful man with a high number of connections to very wealthy people. This made it hard for the Justice Department to accuse and arrest him. Extreme wealth and high levels of connections create a wall of protection for anyone, no matter what the wrongdoing was.

Conclusion

Although our Figures use different parts of the data, all of them point to the same idea: Jefferey Epstein had strong interpersonal connections with people of all different professions that helped him become the powerful man he was known to be. Figure 1 and 2 go into details about who he was in contact with. These people not only helped his court case with what information came out, but the figures point to the idea that some information was suppressed by these contacts to protect Epstein. These people in high positions of power not only were in contact with Epstein all the time, sending hundreds of thousands of messages, but also in contact for about a dozen years (Figure 3). This long lasting, high frequency contact is what allowed Epstein to stay in power for so long despite legal and financial hits. All of this goes to say that it really is about the people you know, and Jeffrey Epstein had the right people on his side which allowed him to hide behind a protective wall for many years.

Future Predictions

So, we have looked at our data and drawn our conclusions... but where does this lead? What do we think will happen now? As for what to study next, we think studying the actual emails themselves, what was said, and what Epstein's response was, would be extremely interesting. This would help us flesh out the skeleton of data we have presented here. The context of the emails would round out our whole presentation. If we had more time or resources, we absolutely would have taken context into account. Beyond the context, we think it would be interesting to create a similar network analysis with the names mentioned in emails, not just the names of those who sent emails. For example, Donald Trump has been one of the most contentious members of Epstein's network, especially with his current position as President of the United States, and what his involvement could mean in terms of the state of the American government. However, while we could not provide proof that Trump actually sent an email to Epstein himself, upon exploring some of the contents of the emails on Jmail, we found his name was mentioned in hundreds of emails that point to him being guilty of sexual crimes with women and minors (Igel).

As for our recommendations, we are going to go down two lanes here. The first is the tightening of security across a lot of fronts. Legally, there will most likely be stricter policies in organizations like JPMorgan Chase, Morgan Stanley, and other investment banks when it comes to how a person's finances are handled, and especially the ability to transfer or wire large amounts of money without clear requests or reasoning. There will also likely be more attention placed on public financiers like Jeffrey Epstein, not only looking at the amount of wealth they have, but how they got there and the ethicality behind it.

At the same time, we do not want to be naive. We know that elite networks will always have some ability to keep secrets through financial power, blackmail, and alliances. But with that said, there is still a sense of hope that laws will continue to tighten around issues like human trafficking, missing persons, illegal financing, misuse of another person's money, and embezzlement. The second lane is centered around voice. We predict that the voices of those who have been trafficked, gone missing, or experienced abuse will be heard at much greater levels. No matter who they are accusing, regardless of that person's social, political, or financial status. We also predict that victims connected to Epstein's crimes will use their platforms to push others to speak out and take action against the individuals and organizations that have abused or failed them.

The release of the Epstein files has already brought global attention to many of these issues, and it is our hope that moving forward they are handled with integrity, with the wellbeing of victims actually placed at the center.

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AI Statement:

We Acknowledge the use of Grammarly for sentence and spelling corrections. We chose to not use any other Artificial Intelligence platforms as we felt it would take away from the project by not staying true to our original thoughts.



Texas Christian University

Dr. Hannah Jorgensen

Digital Humanities

Sophia Burns

Carlisle Cohen

Camila Gonzalez

Regan Nugent

